
2026 LPL Financial University Hackathon

5th University Hackathon

Presented by: Sama Ahmed

Date: October 2nd, 2026

Agenda

1. Welcome & Event Overview
2. Prompt Reveal, Judging & Awards
3. Event Resources & Expectations
4. Executive Welcome
5. AWS Innovation Session
6. Hackathon Kickoff

Welcome & Event Overview

Welcome to the 5th University Hackathon

You were selected from nearly 350 applicants to participate. Over the next two days, you'll build, collaborate, and bring an ambitious idea to life.

We're excited to see what you create! 🎉

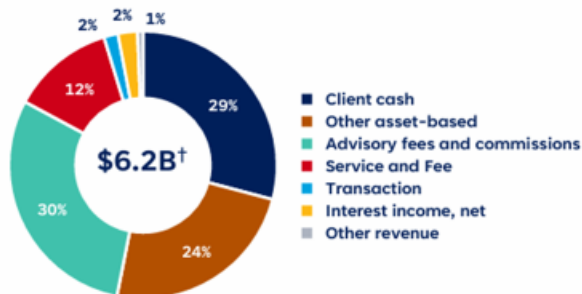
LPL Snapshot (as of June 30, 2026)

For nearly 40 years, we have been providing investment solutions, technology platforms, resources, and services to our financial advisors and institutions across the U.S.

**FORTUNE
500**

No. 264

Gross Profit* Contribution



32,500

Financial
Advisors**



1,100

Financial
Institutions



10,000+

Employees

\$2.6T

Client Assets***

LPL Offices



*Gross profit is calculated as total revenue less advisory and commission expense; brokerage, clearing and exchange expense; and market fluctuations on employee deferred compensation.

**Includes independent advisors, independent RIA, and institution services

***Brokerage and advisory client assets, serviced or custodied.

Teams & Participation Overview



Day 1 Schedule - PT

8:00AM – 9:00AM	Opening Ceremony ○ Opening Remarks, Rules & Prompt Reveal (8:00 – 8:15) ○ Billy Runyun, EVP & CTO, Guest Speaker (8:15 – 8:30) ○ AWS Thought Leadership Segment (8:30 – 8:55)
9:00AM – 9:30AM	Hackathon Begins
9:30AM – 10:30AM	AWS Demo & Account Setup Support
10:30AM – 11:00AM	AWS Q&A / Mini Office Hours
12:00PM	Project Category Selection Opens
1:00PM – 2:00PM	AWS Technical Office Hours
5:00PM – 6:00PM	AWS Technical Office Hours

Note: Office hours are optional. Sign up for an available time slot and breakout room using the shared sign-up sheet and join the main Webex meeting at your scheduled time.

Day 2 Schedule - PT

3:00AM – 4:00AM	Morning Office Hours
9:00AM	Final Submission & Presentation Upload Deadline
9:30AM – 11:00AM	Team Presentations & Judging ○ 5-minute team presentation ○ 5-minute Q&A with judges
11:00AM – 11:30AM	Judging Deliberation Period
11:30AM – 12:30PM	Closing Ceremony & Awards ○ Category Winner Announcements ○ Winning Team Presentations to LPL & AWS Leaders

Day 1 Schedule - ET

11:00AM - 12:00PM	Opening Ceremony ○ Opening Remarks, Rules & Prompt Reveal (11:00 - 11:15) ○ Billy Runyun, EVP & CTO, Guest Speaker (11:15 - 11:30) ○ AWS Thought Leadership Segment (11:30 - 11:55)
12:00PM - 12:30PM	Hackathon Begins
12:30PM - 1:30PM	AWS Demo & Account Setup Support
1:30PM - 2:00PM	AWS Q&A / Mini Office Hours
3:00PM	Project Category Selection Opens
4:00PM - 5:00PM	AWS Technical Office Hours
8:00PM - 9:00PM	AWS Technical Office Hours

Note: Office hours are optional. Sign up for an available time slot and breakout room using the shared sign-up sheet and join the main Webex meeting at your scheduled time.

Day 2 Schedule - ET

6:00AM - 7:00AM	Morning Office Hours
12:00PM	Final Submission & Presentation Upload Deadline
12:30PM - 2:00PM	Team Presentations & Judging ○ 5-minute team presentation ○ 5-minute Q&A with judges
2:00PM - 2:30PM	Judging Deliberation Period
2:30PM - 3:30PM	Closing Ceremony & Awards ○ Category Winner Announcements ○ Winning Team Presentations to LPL & AWS Leaders

Prompt Reveal, Judging & Awards

Present Your Idea to Executive Leadership

Winning teams will present their projects during the Closing Ceremony and receive feedback from LPL executive leaders.



Nitesh Ambastha

EVP, Chief Information Officer



Abhishek Sharma

EVP, Wealth Management Technology



Mamatha Pathipati

SVP, Technology



John Stevens

SVP, AI Product Management

Theme: Startup from the Future

Build the Startup LPL Would Want to Buy

Envision the future of wealth management and build a compliant AI-powered startup that solves a meaningful challenge for advisors, investors, or the teams that support them. Then pitch why LPL should acquire your startup.

Your solution must use at least one AWS service.

Judging Category Overview



Important

Select 2 of the 4 main award categories using the form sent at 12:00 PM PT / 3:00 PM ET. All projects will also be automatically considered for **Best Use of AWS**, meaning each project will be evaluated in **3 categories total**.

Sponsor Category	4 Main Categories			
Best Use of AWS	Startup We'd Buy Tomorrow	Best Technical Execution	Biggest Business Impact	Best Customer Experience
Use AWS services well, right service for the right reason	Clear value proposition	Functionality	Problem significance	User needs
Build it right: secure, reliable, cost-aware, performant	Market opportunity	Technical complexity	Measurable business value	Usability
Solves a real problem	Business viability	Implementation quality	Scalability	Intuitiveness
Make it work: a live demo	Differentiation	Scalability	Impact potential	Overall user experience
Tell the story: know your "why"				

What the 5 Winning Teams Receive



Gift Card

\$100 Amazon gift card
for each team member.



Priority Consideration

Eligible members of winning teams will
receive priority consideration for
LPL Financial early career
opportunities.

Judging Process

01

Category Selection (October 2nd)

At 12:00 PM PT / 3:00 PM ET, teams will receive a form to select 2 judging categories. All projects will also automatically be considered for Best Use of AWS.

02

Breakout Room Assignments (October 3rd)

Prior to judging, teams will receive their assigned breakout room. Each breakout room will include:

- 2 LPL judges
- 1 AWS judge
- 1 moderator

03

Project Presentations (October 3rd | 9:30AM - 11:00AM PT | 12:30PM - 2:00PM ET)

- Present for 5 minutes
- Participate in a 5-minute Q&A session
- Receive evaluation from the judging panel
- We'll send a presentation rubric covering deck content and judging expectations.

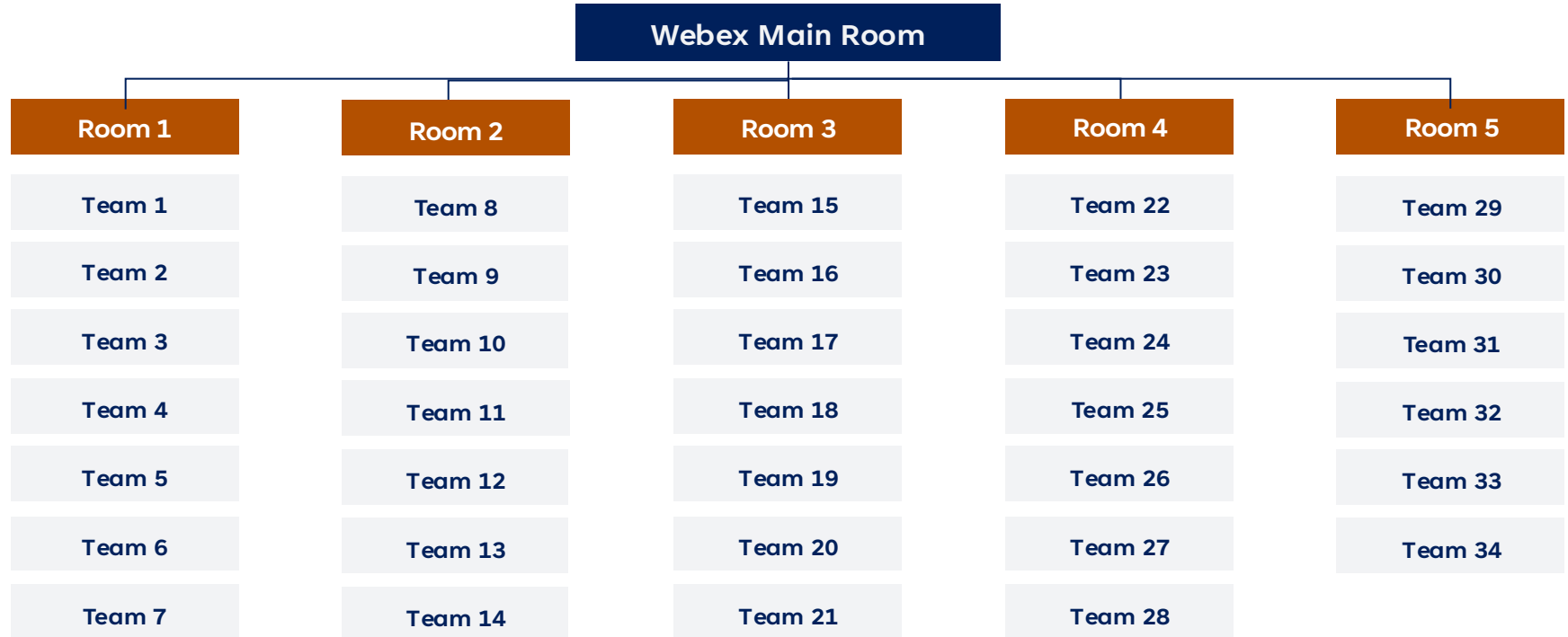
04

Scoring, Deliberation & Winner Showcase (October 3rd)

Judges will score each project and select the category winners. Winning teams will present their projects during the Closing Ceremony.

Judging Room Assignments

Teams will present consecutively within their assigned breakout room. For example, Teams 1 through 7 will present one after another in Room 1.



Support, Resources & Participant Expectations

Support, Resources & Participant Expectations



Support

- Use the **Webex Support Chat** for event logistics, technical questions, or AWS support
- Sign up for **AWS Office Hours** using the shared signup sheet
- Choose one available **15-minute slot** and breakout room
- Enter your **team number** without overwriting another team's signup



Resources

- AWS documentation and tools
- Event resources and templates
 - LPL presentation template
 - Submission forms and instructions



Participant Expectations

- Collaborate with your assigned team
 - Use the provided LPL presentation template
 - Select **2 judging categories**
 - Meet all **submission deadlines**
- Remain **available during judging**
- **Your solution must use at least one AWS service.**

How to Sign Up for Office Hours

We'll post the office hours sign-up sheet in Webex around 11:00 AM PT / 2:00 PM ET.

Office Hours 1 — AWS Technical Support — 1:00–2:00 PM PT 4:00–5:00 PM ET							
Friday, October 2, 2026							
IMPORTANT: Please do not overwrite an existing signup.							
Choose one available time slot and breakout room, then enter your Team #.							
Slot	Pacific Time (PT)	Eastern Time (ET)	Breakout Room 1	Breakout Room 2	Breakout Room 3	Breakout Room 4	Breakout Room 5
1	1:00 PM–1:15 PM	4:00 PM–4:15 PM					
2	1:15 PM–1:30 PM	4:15 PM–4:30 PM					
3	1:30 PM–1:45 PM	4:30 PM–4:45 PM					
4	1:45 PM–2:00 PM	4:45 PM–5:00 PM					

Final Deliverables

Please review these requirements carefully to ensure your team's submission is eligible for judging



Required

- Final presentation deck using the provided LPL PowerPoint template
- Working prototype or demo
- ZIP file containing your project code
- Completed Project Submission Form



Optional

- Recorded demo video, recommended as a backup
- Supporting materials, such as design mockups, technical documentation, or architecture diagrams



Submission Details

- One submission per team
- Upload the **presentation deck and code ZIP file to your assigned Box folder**
- Complete the **Project Submission Form**
- Due by **9:00 AM PT / 12:00 PM ET on October 3**

Acknowledgements

Meet the Team Behind the Hackathon

Thank you to everyone who has devoted their time, energy, and expertise over the past several months to bringing this event to life.



Meet the LPL Judges



Micah McCann

VP Data Service Engineer



Marissa Texeira

VP II, Technology



Lavanya Karanje

VP, Software Dev Manager



Rob Nagle

VP, Engineering Manager



Sweety Deshpande

VP, Software Delivery Manager



Harshit Gupta

Engineer II



Kranti Chettipotula

VP II, Software Engineering



Komal Sutaria

VP, Developer Experience



Jatin Chawla

Principal Software Engineer



Dwayne White

*AIOps Lead – Production
Operations*

Meet the Amazon Web Services Team



Andrea Sabet

*Senior Manager,
Solutions Architecture*



Ravi Thakur

Senior Solutions Architect



Nandhini Balakrishnan

Solutions Architect



Prasad Shetty

Senior Solutions Architect



Joyce Muya

Solutions Architect



Andrew Maxymillian-Wheeler

Senior Solutions Architect



Sam Mathia

Senior Solutions Architect



Bhavin Shah

Senior Solutions Architect



Tsega Tefera

Senior Solutions Architect

Executive Welcome

Billy Runyun

Executive Vice President & Chief Technology Officer





Sponsor Welcome

Sudipt Kapadia

Director, Solutions Architecture



Let the Hackathon Begin!

For support, use the Webex Support Chat.

Questions?

Contact Sama Ahmed at sama.ahmed@lplfinancial.com